

Chunyu ZHAO

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Macau	2023 - 2027 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, The University of British Columbia	2022 - 2023
Honours B.A. in Mathematical Economics, University of Waterloo	2020 - 2022
B.A. in Financial Mathematics, Shandong University of Finance and Economics	2018 - 2022

Research Interests

Market Design, Matching Theory, Experimental Economics

Working Papers

Backward Elicitation of Preferences in Strategy-proof Mechanisms (January 2026) with Inácio Bó and Lawrence Choo
(Presented at *The Fourth Wuhan Cherry Blossom Workshop on Experimental Economics*)

Abstract: We study whether changing preference-elicitation order affects behavior in strategy-proof matching mechanisms. In a laboratory school choice setting, we vary the matching rule (Serial Dictatorship vs. Random Serial Dictatorship) and the ranking procedure (standard vs. backward, eliciting least-preferred schools first). Backward elicitation yields mixed effects: it decreases truthfulness under Random Serial Dictatorship but increases it under Serial Dictatorship. Analysis of decision-making shows participants respond to both payoff differences and perceived school competitiveness, but backward elicitation does not significantly alter sensitivity to either factor.

Papers in Progress

The Informational Value of Historical Cutoffs in Centralized Matching with Inácio Bó and Yubo Tao

Dividing Indivisible Objects with a Random Cutoff with Inácio Bó

A Markov-Chain Approach to Multi-Object Allocation: From Alternating-Pick to Coin-Flip with Inácio Bó

Teaching and Research Experience

<u>Advanced Microeconomics</u> Teaching assistant, with Prof. Inácio Bó (University of Macau)	2024, 2026
<u>Math Camp for Econ PhD Students</u> Instructor (University of Macau)	2025

<u>Experimental Economics Laboratory</u>	2025
Research assistant, with Prof. Lawrence Choo (University of Macau)	
<u>Public Economics</u>	2024
Teaching assistant, with Prof. Guangzhen Sun (University of Macau)	
<u>Intermediate Microeconomics</u>	2024
Teaching assistant, with Prof. Gary Wong (University of Macau)	
<u>Principles of Macroeconomics</u>	2023
Teaching assistant, with Prof. Chowdhury Mahmoud (The University of British Columbia)	
<u>Making Sense of Economic Data</u>	2022
Teaching assistant, with Prof. Jonathan Graves (The University of British Columbia)	

Fellowships

UM PhD Assistantship (University of Macau)	2023–2027
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Software

Python, R, MATLAB, Stata, oTree/z-Tree, L^AT_EX

Languages

Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

References

Available upon request